

PipeFit Pro — User Guide

Everything in this app does one job: turn what you can **measure** into what you have to **cut**.

This guide goes module by module. For each one: what it is for, what to measure, what to type, what comes back, **why it comes back that way**, and how to check it against your own head before you cut steel.

Part 1 — Read this first

The one thing the whole app is about

A drawing gives you **centre-to-centre**. A saw needs **cut length**. They are never the same number, because a fitting occupies some of the distance between two centres.



Cut = centre-to-centre – takeout A – takeout B – any weld gaps.

Every module in this app is that sentence, worked for a different shape of job. Once you see it, the app stops being ten calculators and becomes one.

Where the numbers come from

Nothing here is a rule of thumb someone remembered.

KIND OF NUMBER	SOURCE
Fitting takeouts	The Lindsey Pipefitters Handbook tables, transcribed and checked
Pipe OD and wall	ASME B36.10M
Butt weld fittings	ASME B16.9
Flanges	ASME B16.5
Screwed fittings	ASME B16.3
Pipe threads	ASME B1.20.1
Miter code limit	ASME B31.3 §304.2.3
Bend geometry	The bend radius, worked exactly

1,370 automated tests run on every change. Ten misprints were found in the printed handbook while transcribing it, and each one is pinned by a test so it cannot quietly come back.

Why you can trust it without second-guessing

The app is checked against the multipliers a fitter already carries in his head. Multiply the offset by these:

FITTING ANGLE	TRAVEL	RUN	SHRINK
11.25°	× 5.126	× 5.027	× 0.098
22.5°	× 2.613	× 2.414	× 0.199
30°	× 2.000	× 1.732	× 0.268
45°	× 1.414	× 1.000	× 0.414
60°	× 1.155	× 0.577	× 0.577
90°	× 1.000	× 0	× 1.000

The app agrees with every one of them to **four decimal places**, and a test proves it on every build. If it ever disagrees with that table, the app is wrong — not the table.

Set three things once

Settings (gear, top right of any screen).

SETTING	SET IT TO	WHY
Default size	The pipe you are on today	Every screen opens on it. Saves a tap on every job.
Weld gap	Your standard root gap, default 3/32"	Comes off welded and flanged ends only. A screwed or soldered joint pulls up tight and never has it deducted.
Fractions	1/16 for most work, 1/32 or 1/64 for tight tolerance	The decimal above the fraction is always the exact figure. Cut to the decimal when it matters.
Length readout	Inches	The calculator stays in inches. Press FT when you actually want feet.

Part 2 — The three ideas everything is built on

1. Takeout — why a fitting "eats" length

An elbow does not start at the centre point. The centre point is where two lines cross in the air; the fitting's face is some distance back from it. That distance is the **takeout**.

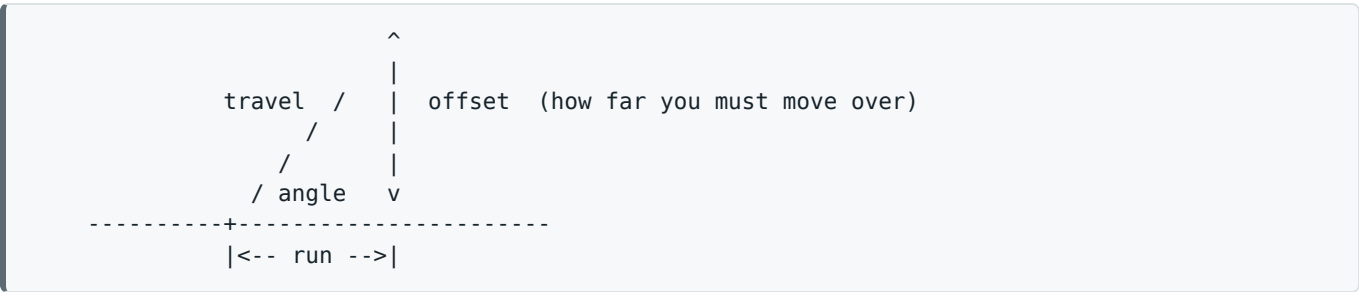
For a **bend you make yourself**, the takeout is pure geometry:

takeout = bend radius × tan(half the angle)

A 2" long radius elbow bends on a 3" radius (1.5 × the size). At 90°, tan 45° = 1, so the takeout is **3"**. At 45°, tan 22.5° = 0.4142, so it is **1.2426"**.

For a **fitting you buy**, the takeout is whatever the manufacturer made it, out of the handbook table.

2. Every offset is a right triangle



- **Offset** — how far the pipe has to shift. You measure this.
- **Run** — how far it advances along the original line while it shifts.
- **Travel** — centre to centre of the two fittings. **This is the number the cut comes from.**
- **Shrink** — travel minus run. What the offset costs you in length.

Pick any two and the third follows. That is all the offset screens do.

3. A bend is NOT a bought fitting

They agree at 90° and disagree everywhere else.

2" LONG RADIUS, 45°	TAKES OUT
Pipe you bent	1.2426"
Elbow you bought	1-3/8"

A run of bought fittings worked to the bend formula cuts **every piece an eighth of an inch long**.

The app keeps them separate on purpose. Cut length offers both, labelled. **Simple offset, Rolling offset** and **Pipe bend** work the bend, because that is what a bender does.

Part 3 — The modules

Simple offset

Get around an obstruction in one plane. The pipe moves one way — up, down, left or right — and carries on.

What to measure

1. **Offset** — how far the pipe must shift to clear the obstruction, centre to centre.
2. Either the **fitting angle** you intend to use, or the **run** you have room for. Not both — the app solves whichever you do not give it.

Step by step

1. Tap **Simple offset**.
2. Set the pipe with the wrench button at the bottom (size, LR/SR, schedule).
3. Type the **Offset**.
4. Tap an angle preset — **45°** is the one you will use most.
5. Read **PIPE CUT**.

What each number means

RESULT	WHAT IT IS	WHY YOU CARE
PIPE CUT	The piece between the two fittings	This is what you cut
Travel	Centre to centre of the two fittings	The cut before deductions
Run	How far it advances along the line	Tells you if it fits the space you have
Shrink	Travel – run	What the offset costs you in overall length
Setback	Takeout per fitting	What comes off each end
Cut angle	The angle the fittings turn through	Confirms the preset took
Inside arc / Outside arc	Throat and back of the bend	Marks for bending, not for buying

Worked example

2" schedule 40, long radius, 12" offset at 45°, default 3/32" gap:

FIGURE	VALUE
Run	12.0000"
Travel	16.9706"
Shrink	4.9706"
Setback (each end)	1.2426"
PIPE CUT	14.2978"

Check it in your head: $12 \times 1.414 = 16.97$ travel ✓. Two takeouts of $1.24 = 2.49$. $16.97 - 2.49 = 14.48$, less two $3/32"$ gaps (0.19) = **14.29** ✓

The square jog — 90°

Preset **90°**. The pipe goes straight across and advances nothing. **Run = 0, travel = the offset.**

24" offset, 2" pipe: run 0, travel 24.00, setback 3.00 each end → **PIPE CUT 17.81"**

When the run is fixed instead

Tap **Set run** and type the run. The angle falls out of it and shows as **Cut angle**. A run of **0** gives you the square jog.

Use this when the space along the line is what is tight, not the angle.

Where people go wrong

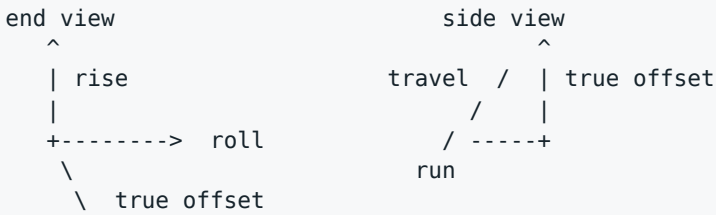
- **Measuring the offset to the pipe surface instead of the centre.** Everything in this app is centre to centre.
- **Forgetting the gap is already off.** PIPE CUT is ready to cut. Do not deduct again.
- **Using a 45° preset while installing bought 45° elbows.** This screen works a *bend*. For bought fittings use **Cut length**, which has both.

Rolling offset

The obstruction makes the pipe move two ways at once — up *and* over. A rolling offset is a simple offset that has been rotated around the pipe.

Why it is two triangles, not one

Look down the pipe from the end. The **rise** (up/down) and the **roll** (left/right) are two legs of a right triangle. Their hypotenuse is the **true offset** — the real, straight-through distance the pipe has to move.



Then the **true offset** and the **run** form a second right triangle whose hypotenuse is the **travel**. Same theorem twice. That is the whole of it.

Step by step

1. Tap **Rolling offset**.
2. Set the pipe.
3. Type **Rise / set** (up or down) and **Roll** (left or right).
4. Tap an **Elbow angle** preset, or tap **Run** to fix the run instead.
5. Read **PIPE CUT**.

What each number means

RESULT	WHAT IT IS
True offset	The real diagonal distance, straight through
Roll angle	How far around the pipe the offset lies — which way to point the fitting
Travel C2C	Centre to centre of the two fittings
Run	Advance along the original line
PIPE CUT	The piece between them

The roll angle is the one people miss. It is not a cut dimension — it tells you how far to rotate the fitting around the pipe so the offset lands where you measured it.

Worked example

2" schedule 40 LR, rise 12", roll 9", 45° elbows:

FIGURE	VALUE
True offset	15.0000"
Roll angle	36.87°
Run	15.0000"
Travel C2C	21.2132"
Setback	1.2426"
PIPE CUT	18.5404"

Check it: 12 and 9 is a 3-4-5 triangle scaled by three — true offset **15** ✓. At 45° the run equals the true offset, 15 ✓. Travel = $15 \times 1.414 = 21.21$ ✓

Where people go wrong

- **Entering the true offset in the rise box.** Rise and roll are the two *separate* measurements. The app works the true offset out.
 - **Ignoring the roll angle.** Get it wrong and the spool is geometrically perfect and points the wrong way.
 - **Rise and roll both zero** — there is no offset to solve, and the app says so.
-

Cut length

The most used screen in the app. You have a centre-to-centre dimension off a drawing and a fitting on each end.

Step by step

1. Tap **Cut length**.
2. Set the pipe.
3. Type **C2C length**.
4. Pick **Joint** — screwed, welded, flanged or soldered.
5. If flanged, pick the **Class** — 150, 300, 600 and up.
6. Pick **End A** and **End B**.
7. Read **PIPE CUT**.

Why the joint family matters

It changes two things at once:

1. **Which table the takeout comes from.** A screwed 90 and a welded 90 in the same size are different castings with different dimensions.
2. **Whether the weld gap is deducted.** Welded and flanged ends leave a root gap. Screwed and soldered joints pull up tight and never have one deducted.

That second one was a real bug once. It is now a rule in the code and a test.

Worked example

24" C2C, 2" schedule 40, welded long radius 90 on both ends:

FIGURE	VALUE
End A takeout	3.0000"
End B takeout	3.0000"
Total deduction	6.0000"
PIPE CUT	18.0000"
Weight	5.48 lb

With a 1/8" gap on both ends: **17.75"**

Anything not on the list

Pick **Custom** on that end and type the takeout yourself. Use it for a valve, a strainer, a specialty fitting, or anything a vendor drawing gives you directly.

Where people go wrong

- **Leaving the joint on the wrong family.** Check the **Joint** chip before you read the number.
- **Assuming a 45 is a 45.** A bought 45 and a bent 45 have different takeouts. Both are on the list, labelled.
- **Not setting the class on flanged.** A 150 and a 300 flange are not the same length.

Thread engagement

How far a threaded joint pulls up, and what that does to your cut.

Why a threaded joint is different

On a welded joint the pipe stops at the fitting face. On a threaded joint the pipe **screws into** the fitting — so the pipe reaches past the face, and the deduction is smaller than the fitting's centre-to-face.

Deduction per end = fitting centre-to-face – total engagement

Engagement has two parts:

- **Hand tight (L1)** — how far it goes in by hand. From ASME B1.20.1.
- **Wrench makeup** — how far your wrench turns take it further. Each turn advances the pipe by one **pitch**, and pitch is $1 \div \text{threads per inch}$.

Step by step

1. Tap **Thread engagement**.
2. Tap the **Size**.
3. Set **Wrench turns** if you pull up tighter or looser than standard.
4. Type **C2C length** to get the cut.

Worked example

1" NPT, standard 3 wrench turns, 24" centre to centre:

FIGURE	VALUE	WHERE IT COMES FROM
Threads per inch	11.5	from the standard
Pitch	0.0870"	$1 \div 11.5$
Hand tight (L1)	0.4000"	from the standard
Wrench makeup	0.2609"	3×0.0870
Total engagement	0.6609"	hand tight + wrench
Thread remaining	0.3236"	what is left unused
Fitting centre-to-face	1.5000"	B16.3 90° elbow
Deduction per end	0.8391"	$1.5000 - 0.6609$
PIPE CUT	22.3217"	$24 - 2 \times 0.8391$

Watch "Thread remaining". If it goes negative the joint is over-threaded — the pipe bottoms out before it seals.

Where people go wrong

- **Using the welded takeout on screwed pipe.** It is a different, bigger number and the piece comes out short.
- **Not adjusting wrench turns to how you actually pull up.** Two extra turns on 1" pipe moves the cut by about 3/16" over two ends.

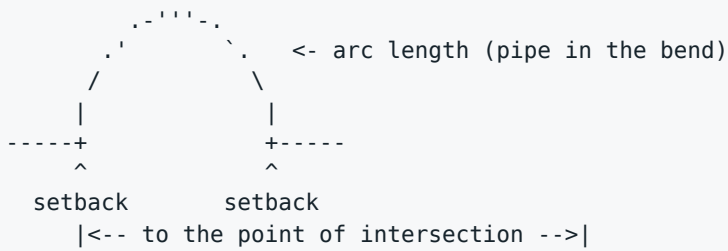
Pipe bend

Any angle, any radius, on your own bender. This is where the marks come from.

Why bending needs different numbers from cutting

When you bend, the pipe does not go round the corner — it cuts the corner on an arc. Three numbers describe that:

- **Setback** — from the point where the two legs would cross, back to where the bend starts. $\text{radius} \times \tan(\text{half the angle})$.
- **Arc length** — how much pipe is actually inside the bend.
- **Gain** — tangent total minus arc. **What you save by bending instead of mitring the corner.** Forget it and every piece comes out long.



Step by step

1. Tap **Pipe bend**.
2. Pick the **Size**, then a **Radius** rule — 3D tight, 5D common field minimum, 10D long sweep — or type a radius.
3. Type the **Angle**.
4. Type **Leg A** and **Leg B**, measured **to the point of intersection**.
5. Set **Stock** if you want to know how many legs come out of a length.
6. Read the marks.

Worked example

2" pipe, 5D radius (10"), 45°, legs 30" and 30":

FIGURE	VALUE
Setback (per tangent)	4.1421"
Arc length	7.8540"
Gain	0.4303"
Tangent total	8.2843"
Mark from end	25.8579"
End of bend	33.7118"
Piece length	59.5697"

Check it: setback = $10 \times \tan 22.5^\circ = 4.142 \checkmark$. Mark = $30 - 4.142 = 25.858 \checkmark$. Arc = $10 \times 45^\circ$ in radians = $10 \times 0.7854 = 7.854 \checkmark$

At 90°, 5D radius, legs 24" and 18": setback 10.00, arc 15.71, gain 4.29, mark from end 14.00, piece 37.71.

Springback

If your bender overbends, put your known springback in and the app gives you the **overbend angle** to pull to. Leave it at zero if you have already dialled it out.

Saddle bend

Jump over a pipe or a beam without changing the line the conduit runs on. It goes up, over, and back down to exactly where it was.

Three point or four point

- **Three point** — for a round obstruction. One centre bend with two half-angle bends either side.
- **Four point** — for a wide obstruction. Two offsets back to back with a flat run over the top. Needs the **Width**.

Why the centre bend is double the side bends

The conduit has to come back to the same line it started on. If the centre bend turns it through 45° , each side bend must turn it back through half that — 22.5° — for the two ends to end up parallel.

Step by step

1. Tap **Saddle bend**.
2. Pick **Three point** or **Four point**.
3. Type the **Depth** — how far it has to rise to clear.
4. Type **To obstruction** — from the conduit end to the centre of the obstruction.
5. On a four point, type the **Width**.
6. Pick the centre bend angle.
7. Bend at the marks, in order.

Worked example

Three point, 2" deep, 20" from the end, 45° centre bend:

FIGURE	VALUE
Side bend angle	22.5°
Multiplier	2.6131
Shrink per bend pair	0.3978"
Total shrink	0.7956"
Developed length	10.4525"
Minimum clearance	4.8284"

MARK	AT	BEND	NOTE
Mark 1	15.172"	22.5°	Bend up, arrow to the centre mark
Centre	20.398"	45°	Bend over the obstruction
Mark 3	25.624"	22.5°	Bend down, back to level

Check it: spacing = depth × multiplier = $2 \times 2.6131 = 5.226$ ". Centre mark is at $20 + 0.398$ shrink = 20.398, and the outer marks sit 5.226 either side ✓

Minimum clearance is the one to watch. If the obstruction is closer to the end than that figure, the first bend would fall off the end of the conduit — and the app refuses rather than giving you a mark you cannot make.

Miter bend

Make an elbow out of straight pipe when you do not have a fitting, or the size does not come as one.

How the cut angle is worked out

With n segments you make $n - 1$ cuts. Each cut face turns the pipe by **twice** the angle you cut it at, because both halves tilt. So:

$$\text{cut angle} = \text{total turn} \div (2 \times \text{number of cuts})$$

A 90° elbow in 4 segments is 3 cuts, so each cut is $90 \div 6 = 15^\circ$.

The two **end segments** have one mitred face. The **middle segments** have two, so their total included angle is double.

Throat is the short side of a segment, **back** is the long side. They come from the centreline radius minus and plus half the pipe OD.

Step by step

1. Tap **Miter bend**.
2. Type the **Total turn** and pick the **Segments**.
3. Set the **Centreline radius**.
4. Mark and cut throat and back lengths on each segment.

Worked example

90° total, 4 segments, 2" schedule 40, 6" centreline radius:

FIGURE	VALUE
Cuts	3
Cut angle	15.00°
End segment	15.00° (one mitred face)
Mid segment	30.00° (two mitred faces)
Throat length	2.5790"
Back length	3.8518"
Cutback	0.6364"
Centreline arc	9.4248"

Check it: 2" pipe OD is 2.375", so half is 1.1875. Throat = $2 \times (6 - 1.1875) \times \tan 15^\circ = 2 \times 4.8125 \times 0.2679 = 2.579$ ✓

The code check

Above a **22.5° cut angle** the app warns you: ASME B31.3 §304.2.3 requires design verification for miters above that. It does not stop you — it tells you, because that is an engineering decision, not a field one.

More segments = smaller cut angle = a smoother, stronger elbow. If you get the warning, add a segment.

3D spool

Build a whole run and look at it before you cut any of it.

How a spool is described

Each leg turns off the one before it by two numbers:

- **Bend** — how far it turns (the elbow angle).
- **Roll** — how far around the previous leg's axis that turn is pointed.

Roll is the part people find odd. With a 90° bend and 0° roll the pipe turns up. Same 90° bend at 90° roll and it turns sideways instead. Bend says *how much*, roll says *which way*.

Step by step

1. Tap **3D spool**.
2. Set the pipe and the gap.
3. Set the first leg's **Length**.
4. **Add leg**, then give it a length, a **Bend** and a **Roll**.
5. Drag the picture to turn it. **NE / NW / SW / SE** jump to the four isometric corners.
6. **Hold a leg in the picture and drag along it** to stretch or shorten it.

7. Read **TOTAL PIPE** and the per-leg cuts.

Worked example

2" schedule 40 LR, three legs: 36", then 24" at 90°, then 30" at 90°, 3/32" gap:

FIGURE	VALUE
Centre to centre	90.00"
Total pipe	77.63"
Elbows	2

LEG	C2C	CUT
1	36.00"	32.91"
2	24.00"	17.81"
3	30.00"	26.91"

Leg 1 loses one takeout (it has a fitting on one end only). Leg 2 sits between two elbows and loses two. That is the whole difference, and you can see it in the numbers.

Turning the spool over

Three controls, and **not one of them changes a cut**. The cut comes from the leg length and the takeout, the takeout comes from the bend angle, and all three of these touch only the roll. Turn a spool over as many times as you like: the pipe you buy and the pieces you cut are the same pieces.

CONTROL	WHERE	WHAT IT DOES
Mirror	under the legs	The opposite hand. Same lengths, same bends, every roll reversed.
Flip all	under the legs	Every leg turns the other way. What ran up now runs down.
⬆ on a leg	on the leg's row	Turns that one leg the other way, and everything past it comes with it.

Mirror is the one you want when the same spool is needed handed for the other side of a rack. **Flip all** is the one you want when the whole run should fold the other way.

A flat spool is its own mirror. If nothing has any roll in it, the spool lies in one plane, and reflecting a flat thing in its own plane does nothing. That is not the button failing — it is what a flat spool is. Use **Flip all** to fold it the other way instead. The hint under the buttons tells you which case you are in.

Flipping one leg carries the legs after it. That is correct and it is what you want: each leg is described as a turn off the one before, so they travel with it rather than the spool breaking in half.

Why the drawing is drawn the way it is

It is a **true isometric** projection — yaw -45° , pitch 35.264° . That is the only orientation where all three axes are foreshortened equally and sit 120° apart, and it is what makes iso paper read as solid instead of flat.

Rotation is limited to about **260°** on purpose. The angles that are missing are the ones where the spool goes edge-on and legs hide behind each other. They are not skipped past — they are not in the range at all, so no matter how far you drag, every leg stays visible.

Calculator

A trade calculator that understands feet, inches and fractions — and **stays in inches**.

How to enter a dimension

Type the number, **then** the unit. Not the other way round.

YOU WANT	PRESS
30 inches	3 0 Inch
6 feet	6 Feet
30-1/2 inches	3 0 Inch 1 / 2 Inch
6 foot 3	6 Feet 3 Inch

It stays in inches

30 Inch × 6 = gives **180"**, not 15 feet. The **IN** marker top left tells you which unit you are reading.

- **Feet** converts what is on display to feet and inches — 2' 6". The marker changes to **FT-IN**.
- **Inch** takes it back.
- The choice sticks until you change it, and survives a **Clear**.

The trade keys

The dark keys along the top are the pipefitting ones. **Conv** turns on the second function printed above each key.

KEY	WHAT IT DOES
Offset, Run, Travel	Enter any two, the third solves
Angle/Slope	Angle or slope of a run
Pipe Size, Pipe Mat'l	Set the pipe for the trade keys
Circle, x², √x	Area and diameter work
Store / Rcl	Hold a figure while you work something else

Where people go wrong

- **Pressing the unit first.** It does nothing. Number, then unit.

- **Reading the fraction instead of the decimal.** The fraction is rounded to your setting. The decimal is exact.

Handbook

Every table from the printed book, searchable, **with its page number on it.**

Use it when you want to see the figure the calculation used rather than take it on trust. Search by what you are looking for — "reducer", "flange", "copper", "support" — and the table comes up with its source page so you can check it against the book in your truck.

Settings

SETTING	WHAT IT DOES
Theme	Light, dark or follow the phone
Units	Imperial or metric
Fractions	Off, 1/8, 1/16, 1/32, 1/64
Length readout	Inches, or feet + inches, for the calculator
Default size	Pipe every screen opens on
Weld gap	Your standard root gap
Stock length	Length you buy, for counting legs out of a stick
Updates	What is running, and a manual check

Settings are stored on the phone only. Nothing leaves it.

Part 4 — Knowing when to trust it

What is exact and what is not

FIGURE	VALUE
Exact	Every length, angle, takeout, arc and cut. These are geometry and published tables.
Estimate, and labelled as one	Fitting weights. They are geometric approximations, not vendor catalogue figures. Pipe weight itself is exact.

Fractions versus decimals

The fraction is **rounded to the nearest tick** of the denominator you picked. The decimal above it is the exact figure.

On a 10-foot run at 1/16" rounding you can be out by up to 1/32". Usually nothing. On a tight flange-to-flange fit-up it is not nothing. **Cut to the decimal when the tolerance is tight.**

When the app refuses to answer

It refuses rather than guessing, and it tells you why:

MESSAGE	WHAT IT MEANS
"Fitting takeoffs exceed travel"	The fittings are longer than the space. No pipe between them. Use a smaller angle or a shorter radius.
"Obstruction is too close to the conduit end"	The first bend would fall off the end. Move the mark or use a steeper angle.
"Fitting angle past 90° turns the run back on itself"	Past 90° the pipe doubles back. That is not an offset.
"Cut angle exceeds 22.5°"	Code check, ASME B31.3. Not a refusal — add a segment or get it verified.
"Thread remaining" going negative	Over-threaded. The pipe bottoms out before it seals.

A refusal is information. It is the app telling you the job as measured cannot be built that way — which is much better news before you cut than after.

The habit worth keeping

For anything that matters, do this once:

1. Read **PIPE CUT**.
2. Check **Travel** against the multiplier table in Part 1.

3. Check the **takeout** looks right for the fitting in your hand.

Three seconds, and you will never wonder whether the number is good.

PipeFit Pro. Built for the job, tested against the book.